

MINUTES

Evaluation Subcommittee Meeting

March 27, 2023
5:00pm - 6:00pm

The meeting was held remotely via Zoom and viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 15 and Verizon Channel 45 starting at 5:00 p.m.

Attendance: Member Hays (Chair), Member Graham, Member McLaughlin

Roll Call: 3/0

Central Administration: Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Joan Bowen, Suzanne Galusi

Members of the Public: *unknown*

MEMORANDUM

As approved by the School Committee on February 1, 2023 (2023-3): it is agreed the Evaluation Subcommittee will meet to review and develop the process for the 2022-2023 Superintendent Evaluation.

AGENDA

As approved by the Evaluation Subcommittee on Thursday February 16, 2023, the Subcommittee will meet to:

1. Discuss template options for the Superintendent evaluation and select one for this year.
2. Discuss instructions to provide members to complete their individual evaluations of the Superintendent using the template.

Member Hays presents the DESE End of Cycle Summative Evaluation Report for Superintendent Template, showing various fillable check boxes for ratings, comments, and performance goals and ratings for focus indicators. This is the most common and standard one being used by a number of school districts. The same form is recommended to be used for the final composite evaluation of the Superintendent.

Member Graham would like to use a format that allows the use of the focus indicators the school committee is wanting to focus on. She feels the form is too comprehensive, having every indicator available and filling it out would be confusing and tedious. Also asks how would it be compiled?

Chair/Member Hays comments, one of the main goals of the subcommittee is for the process to align with DESE and therefore feels it would make sense to use the Form available from DESE. In response to the compilation of the data, her intention is to create a form and compile the answers as returned by school committee members. Member Ruseau has the means to compile the numbers, as was done last year.

Chair/Member Hays also comments that last year's Form (2022) was difficult to read and members found it challenging to complete. This form is clearer and more straightforward.

Member Graham offers an alternative suggestion and shares her screen to show a rough Google form. Chair/Member Hays confirms it aligns with what she would consolidate into a manageable and reportable form and continues to lean towards the DESE Form, which is in a more user friendly format.

Member McLaughlin sees how Member Hays likes the DESE format and expectations; the DESE form has more values than what the school committee members are evaluating on. Questions if it is possible to edit the DESE form to reflect the indicators and aspects required and being looked for in evaluating.

Chair/Member Hays indicates this would require recreating a new form every year to reflect different indicators.

Member McLaughlin sees the rationale and as long as the instructions are explicit as to which line items people are to complete, as future goals and indicators are considered.

Chair/Member Hays shares instructions obtained from Concord School District to accompany the evaluation. Confirms the presentation of the Evaluation Template will be at the COW Meeting scheduled for May 8, 2023.

Member Graham confirms the instructions are “generally fine” and points out the template has to match the instructions.

Chair/Member Hays confirms it is associated with the DESE Evaluation template and shares rating for focus indicators for each Standard 2, 3 and 4 to be checked off, outlining that each one has its own comment box. ‘Proficient’ is the only one not required but is recommended. The individual would fill out the form, complete and determine with a summary (or a compilation if more than one) and decide their individual ratings for the evaluation.

Member Graham inquires as to what would be aggregated.

Chair/Member Hays confirms that what is being shown on screen is what will be used.

Superintendent Edourd-Vincent speaks to the same information being given under each standard. There are two or more indicators the committee selected that can be highlighted for completion with feedback or comments to be listed in the blue box below. Combined rating can be based on the evidence provided. DESE is looking for an overall rating in Standard 1 - Instructional Leadership. If, as a district, the focus is on two indicators, the individual provides a rating for those indicators and then provides an overall rating for the umbrella category - Instructional Leadership. It's saying the same thing; it's being presented differently. Member Graham's spreadsheet allows the members to go and specifically target the 8 indicators; DESE's template would show the other indicators but members would not be required to put ratings into anything but the 8 indicators chosen for completion.

Member Graham is not in favor of a big complicated form for a small number of things; is of the opinion the simpler the form is, the easier it is on everyone and that a lot of healthy dialogue and important feedback that took place in 2022 will not happen and be lost to the committee and the superintendent.. She is of the opinion it is important for all members to hear from each other.

Chair/Member Hays comments that last year's process was confusing as to how things were aggregated. Specific focus ratings were not chosen. It's a different format for the same information, with words and comment boxes, as opposed to number ratings.

Member Graham does not want to see the process diluted where meaningful feedback is lost.

Member McLaughlin asks for clarity and an explanation around the 'dilution piece' would be helpful. The data gets aggregated however there are still individual assessments that will be submitted into public record and the community will have access to.

Chair/Member Hays responds that there are pros and cons for each of the indicators and this can be made clear in the instructions.

Member McLaughlin comments on quantitative vs. qualitative data and that it would be collective. She is of the opinion it is good to have the option to do both. The aggregated data goes out to DESE without the narrative. The community, Superintendent and School Committee would benefit from this feedback. transparency of information to the community is important.

Chair/Member Hays looks for clarification on raw data and how the results get shared to the community. Refers to other districts procedures and processes. All ratings and comments should be publically available.

Member McLaughlin summarizes - she likes the whole form; it shows the overall and reminds there are other indicators to be looked at in the future. She likes using a standardized form that won't change from year to year regardless of who is in office. She likes having both the final aggregated data put together to be sent to DESE and the dis-aggregated data by individual members to be made available to the public.

Motion by Member McLaughlin to take the DESE Form with the Qualitative and Quantitative Data, ensuring that all of the individual evaluations and combined evaluations are to be available and made public; seconded by Chair/Member Hays
Motion passes 2/1 with Member Graham in the negative

The following meeting date of **April 24, 2023** is to be kept as scheduled, to review the materials and instructions.

Chair/Member Hays will share DESE evaluation materials with other members, with the understanding that they can be reviewed individually but cannot be collaborated on until the public meeting.

No emails were received from any public participants.

Motion to Adjourn by Member McLaughlin; seconded by Member Graham.
Motion Carries 3/0

Meeting Adjourns: 5:58pm